

SACRED GOLD PLUS



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What is new in 1.2

This guide shows, with frames from the running game, what changes between 1.1 and 1.2: the options page that opens with SELECT, the camera indoors, the three network connections and the text corrections.

Everything that was in 1.1 is still there. What follows is only what 1.2 adds, and how far each addition was actually tested.

English document · version 1.2

Every picture is a frame taken from the running game.

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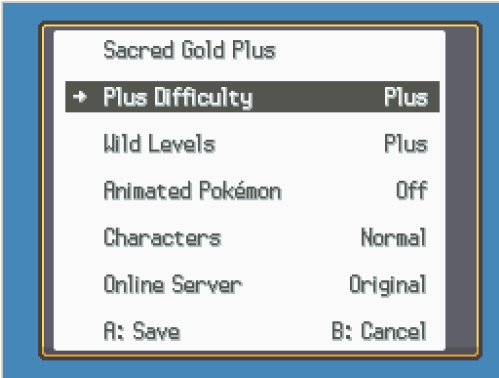
The options page: press SELECT

The biggest change in 1.2 is that the game now has an options page of its own. Press SELECT while playing and it opens.

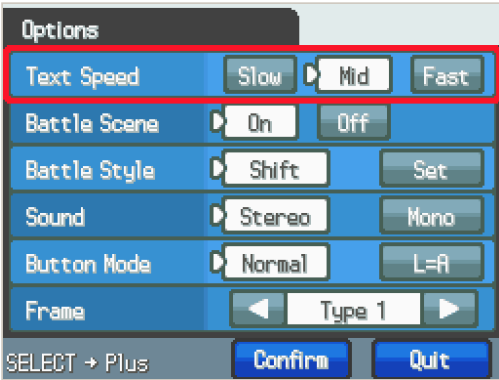
The choices are written into the save, so they survive closing the emulator and a cold start.

None of these settings has a cheat, and none needs one: they are part of the game. Do not look for a "Plus difficulty" or "Animated Pokémon" code in the Cheats folder. It is not there, and that is deliberate.

The game's own Options menu was not touched: it stayed byte-identical. All that appears at the bottom of it is a reminder, **SELECT → Plus**, pointing at the new page.



The page: five settings and, at the foot, the two commands. Up and down move the cursor, left and right change the value.



The Options menu as it always was. Bottom left, the reminder for the new page.

The five settings

1	Plus Difficulty. Harder trainers and levels. It is the difficulty this line of projects always had, now switchable without changing game.	NORMAL / PLUS
2	Wild Levels. Wild Pokémon grow in level along with your progress, instead of staying at the levels of the area.	NORMAL / PLUS
3	Animated Pokémon. Movement of the battlers during a battle. Ships off.	OFF / ON

- 4 Characters. Spreads the loading of the people you meet in the street over several frames, and takes the stutter out of towns. Ships on "smooth".

NORMAL / SMOOTH

- 5 Online Server. Which of the three network connections configured in the console the online services use.

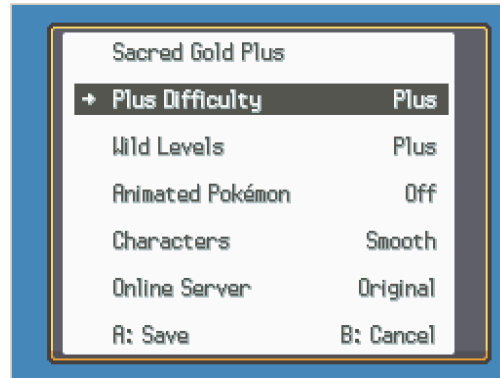
ORIGINAL / CONN. 2 / CONN. 3

Below the five rows sit the two commands:

A: Save writes the choices into the save and closes, B: Cancel closes and changes nothing.

The page always shows the value the game is really using at that moment, not a value kept somewhere else: if a feature is on, the row says so.

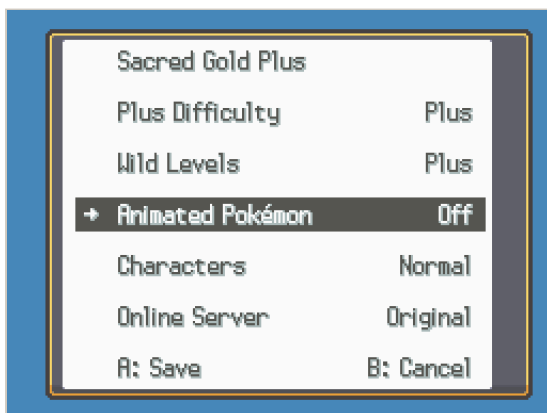
Observed: on ten starts out of ten the page opened, the choices survived a save and a cold start, and the game's original Options menu stayed byte-identical.



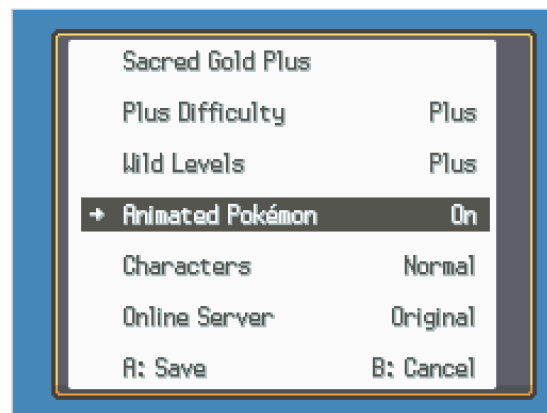
The **Characters** row reads the value in force: here it is **Smooth**, as it ships.

It takes the stylus too

The page answers the stylus the way the game's own menu does: a tap on a row picks it, a tap on the value column picks it and changes the value in one gesture, a tap on the left half of the command row saves, a tap on the right half cancels. Outside the panel nothing happens, and the buttons keep working.



Before the tap: **Animated Pokémon** is **Off**.



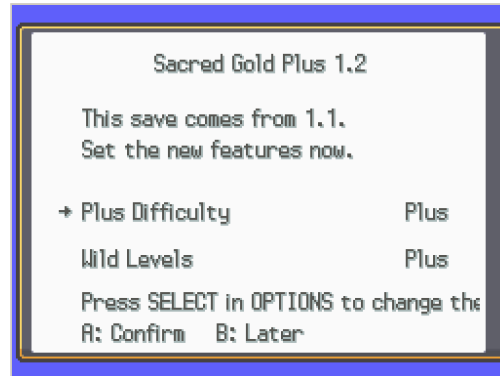
One tap on the value column: the row is picked and the value has already moved to **On**.

The question at the first Continue

The first time you press Continue with a save that comes from 1.1, the game asks once how you want the two settings that change the playthrough: difficulty and wild levels.

Answer with A to confirm, with B to decide later. Either way they are always in the options page, and the screen itself says so.

It does not come back after the first time.



The question that appears once, at the first Continue.

Wild levels

With **Wild Levels on Plus**, the Pokémon you meet in the grass and in the caves rise in level along with your progress, instead of staying at the levels set for that area.



Setting off: the area's own level, as ever.



Setting on, same map: an encounter that would have been level 34 came out at 36.

The two frames are two different encounters, not the same one with the switch flipped: they are there to show that the formula really does change a level on screen.

People in town

When you walk into a new area, the game loads everyone who lives there in a single go: that is where the stutter at the boundary between two areas came from.

With **Characters on Smooth** that work is spread over several frames. Measured: the worst stutter at the boundary goes from five frames to four, and the runs that showed a five-frame stutter went to none. The worst delay before a person appears is nine frames, about a sixth of a second.



A town at the area boundary, with the setting on.



Without: every character loaded in one frame.



With: the same frame, the work spread over ten.

Animated Pokémon

With **Animated Pokémon on** On the battlers move during a battle, with a barely visible breathing motion.

It ships off, and that is a choice: the effect was not judged good enough to be on by default.

With the switch off the game is byte-identical to the version without this addition: that was checked over more than thirty thousand frames.



A battle, first frame.



The comparison the judgement rests on: at the top the game without the addition, below it the two takes of the movement, and at the foot the differences from the first frame, magnified four times.

The camera indoors

In eight interior maps the Plus camera is now native: no cheat, nothing to switch on.

Outdoors the Plus camera is unchanged.

The change is read when you enter a new map. Standing still shows nothing: you have to walk through a door.

If you prefer HeartGold's original camera everywhere, switch on the camera cheat: it is called "Camera Classic" in the .xml file and "Classic camera" in the .mch file. It is the same code with two labels.

Status: the eight maps are present in the file and were checked against the game's own table; the on-screen result was watched on one map only, in the English game. The other seven and the Italian game were checked against the table alone. The classic-camera cheat's effect has never been watched in play.



Before.



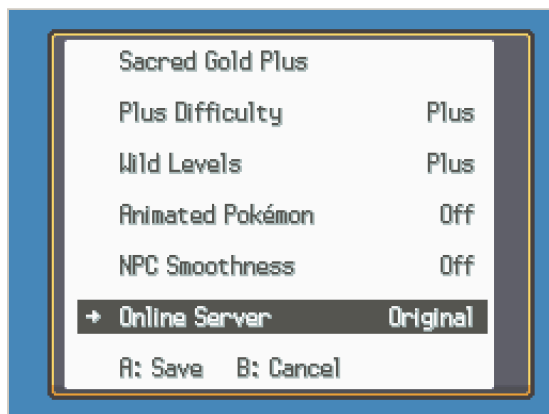
After: same room, same spot, the camera closer in.

Online services: the three connections

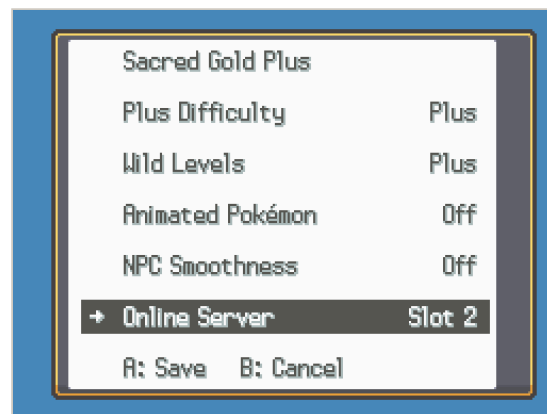
1.2 changes no server address. It only chooses which of the console's three network connections is used by which service:

- Mystery Gift always uses connection 1, automatically;
- GTS, battles and trades use the connection named on the **Online Server** row of the options page.

If the designated connection is not configured, the game uses the first configured one; if none is configured, it behaves exactly as before.



Original: behaves as it did before 1.2.



Conn. 2: GTS, battles and trades go through the second connection.

The DNS, and where it goes

Nintendo's official DS servers have been closed for years. What remains are servers kept by fans, reached by pointing at a different DNS.

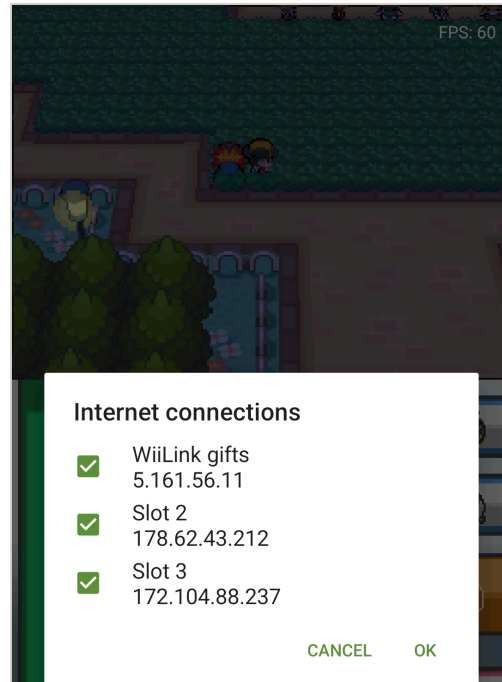
The DNS is set inside the game, not in the emulator: from the Nintendo WFC configuration screen, by choosing one of the three connections and typing the address by hand.



The Nintendo WFC screen with the three connections ready.

Connection 1 5.161.56.11
WiiLink — Mystery Gift
Connection 2 178.62.43.212
Kaeru — GTS, battles, trades
Connection 3 172.104.88.237
AltWFC — alternative

The three addresses 1.2 was designed around,
checked on 12 September 2026.



The same three connections, during testing.

WARNING, PLEASE READ

A third-party DNS sees your name, your friend code, your party and your trades go past. These are servers kept by fans, not by Nintendo, and they are not under this project's control. Use them knowing that, or do not use them. This download contains no emulator and runs no server.

Status: three of the five fallback cases were seen live through Mystery Gift; the two that need a live online service were only checked on an emulated processor, with no crash.

Text corrections

Two hundred and twelve English strings and two Italian ones corrected: fourth-generation glossary terms aligned and typographical fixes. Present in the file and read back.

They are small things, noticeable only when you know where to look — a capital out of place, a term translated two ways — but they are what makes a game feel finished.



One of the corrected screens.

Your 1.1 save carries on

A 1.1 save opens in 1.2, and a 1.2 save opens in 1.1. The two files were compared byte for byte and came out identical; 1.2 keeps its own settings in a block earlier versions ignore.

What has not been tested is a whole playthrough across the change. The *How to install* guide explains how to rename the save and what to check straight afterwards.

The 1.1 cheats no longer apply

melonDS pairs a cheat catalogue with a game using the game code and a check number taken from its header. 1.2 has a different header from 1.1: a 1.1 catalogue will never appear for a 1.2 game.

Import the 1.2 files from the **Cheats** folder, and remove the 1.1 ones if you no longer play 1.1. The instructions are in **Cheats/ABOUT-CHEATS.txt**.

Inside the game, for those who wonder

The 1.2 additions live in a reserved area of 32,768 bytes added to the loaded code. Like the 1.1 reserve, it costs working memory in every scene, permanently, and that cost has not been measured under memory pressure. The 1.1 reserve and its contents were not moved.

What did not go into 1.2

- A level cap above 100. Not in this release: the cap is the one it always was. It is work planned for 1.2b.
- Generation 5 battle animations. Measured and abandoned: those assets are jointed puppets with transforms, not sequences of frames. Porting them would mean a new engine, and it would reproduce the very blur the project did not want. The movement on the "Animated Pokémon" row is what remains of that work.
- Higher-resolution 2D graphics in the emulator: measured as having nothing to do on this game, and postponed.
- A question asked during an online session: deferred, the choice lives in the options page instead.
- Text corrections that could not be confirmed against a published source: deferred.

Known limits

- Nothing in 1.2 has been checked on real Nintendo DS hardware. Every result comes from reading the game's bytes or from an emulator, on a Mac or on an Android device.
- Compatibility with an existing save has not been tested end to end.
- The trainer level shown on screen with Plus difficulty on has not yet been watched in an unfought battle.
- The native indoor camera was watched on one map only, in English.
- Two of the five connection fallback cases were only checked on an emulated processor.
- Repeat use of an item from the bag still does not work, as the 1.1 notes said.
- The third-party cheat catalogue has not been tested on this game.
- On a device running melonDS, a game set to DSi mode stops responding after about fifteen seconds: that is an emulator setting, not a fault in the game.
- Earlier limits from 1.1 and 1.04 still stand: the Italian Pokédex height and weight filters use the original units, some new Fairy moves can play the animation of the move they replaced, and 41 characters are cut from the Italian in-game guide panels.